

actual 'serving'. You need to share the connected disks on the network.

Sharing with Windows/Mac

In the terminal, run 'gksudo nautilus'; this starts up the Ubuntu file manager with root permissions. The difference between sudo (which we used earlier) and gksudo is that sudo is used to run command-line applications as the root while gksudo is used to launch GUI applications as the root. It is pretty similar to 'Run as administrator' command in Windows. Right-click each drive in the left sidebar and click 'Properties' and select 'Share.' Select 'Share this folder' check box in the window that comes up (Fig. 1). The first time you do this, Ubuntu should ask you to install the Windows file sharing service Samba (Fig. 2). Install whatever it asks you to, and then restart the session when prompted.

Start Nautilus from the terminal as the root again. Go back to 'Share' properties panel for a disk, give it a name, and select 'Allow others to create and delete files in this folder' option.



Fig. 2: Install Samba



Fig. 3: Add permissions

Choose 'Add the permissions automatically' button on being prompted (Fig. 3). Click 'Create share.' Repeat these steps for all your drives.

Finally, we need to set up a password for all the shares you have set up. You can do this by running the following command in the terminal:

```
sudo smbpasswd -a userName
```

Replace userName with your Ubuntu username (which you created during installation), and then type and confirm a password for the share. Your password can be anything and is not necessarily your Ubuntu user account password. However, the username needs to be a valid Ubuntu user, otherwise this command will fail. Once you enter your share credentials, you should be able to see all your shared disks. You can also right-click the share and select 'Map network drive' to assign a drive letter to the share. This will also give it a place in Windows Explorer allowing quick and easy access.

Setting up back-ups

One of the most common and important uses for a NAS box is networked back-ups. With your newly set-up NAS box, this is going to be extremely simple, provided you have Windows 7 Professional or a higher version. To set things up, just open 'Start' menu on Windows, and type 'backup' to get to the Windows 'Backup and Restore' utility. Click 'Set Up Backup' and then 'Save on network' button. Proceed to enter the path to your NAS box manually, or browse to discover the server. Choose your back-up settings and set a schedule for your back-ups. I would recommend you connect your computer over Ethernet while the back-up is in progress, to speed things up. If you do not have Windows Professional, you can use an Open Source tool called 'Create



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